

CODING DOJO CAREER PATH GUIDE

Created by Donald Woodard and Susan Myburgh

I. CAREER OPPORTUNITIES

Below you will find a list of potential career paths as well as some common transferable skills, responsibilities and estimated salary ranges for these various paths. This is just a selection of options we find most common for our grads. Use this guide as a starting point to consider the options available to you after you graduate and work further with your designated Career Services Manager to determine how best to leverage your background and your technical skills in order to accomplish your desired career goals.

BACK-END DEVELOPER: *best for individuals who have a strong and natural knack for development. Particularly strong coders with a love for databases and are detail-oriented people.*

Transferable Skills:

Problem Solving
Project Management
Mathematics
Data Analysis
Quality Assurance

General Job Responsibilities:

- Integration of user-facing elements developed by a front-end developers with server side logic
- Building reusable code and libraries for future use
- Optimization of the application for maximum speed and scalability
- Implementation of security and data protection
- Design and implementation of data storage solutions
- Basic understanding of front-end technologies and platforms, such as JavaScript, HTML5, and CSS3
- Good understanding of server-side CSS preprocessors, such as LESS and SASS
- User authentication and authorization between multiple systems, servers, and environments
- Integration of multiple data sources and databases into one system
- Management of hosting environment, including database administration and scaling an application to support load changes
- Data migration, transformation, and scripting
- Setup and administration of backups
- Outputting data in different formats
- Understanding differences between multiple delivery platforms such as mobile vs desktop, and optimizing output to match the specific platform
- Creating database schemas that represent and support business processes
- Implementing automated testing platforms and unit tests
- Proficient knowledge of a back-end programming language {{Depending on the specific case, a developer should have the knowledge of one or more of PHP, Python, Ruby, Java, .NET, JavaScript etc.}}
- Proficient understanding of code versioning tools, such as Git

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- Proficient understanding of OWASP security principles
- Understanding of “session management” in a distributed server environment

Estimated Salary:

\$60,000+ (dependent on experience)

DEV OPS ENGINEER: *best for alumni who have a strong interest in operations as well as development. No clear career track into a role like this, but generally a good fit for people who love planning and deployment as much as coding.*

Transferable Skills:

Planning

Management

Facilitation

Coordination

Data Analysis

Quality Assurance

Customer Service

General Job Responsibilities:

- Utilize various open source technologies
- Use various tools to orchestrate solutions
- Build independent web based tools, microservices and solutions
- Write scripts and automation using Perl/Python/Groovy/Java/Bash
- Configure and manage data sources like MySQL, Mongo, Elasticsearch, Redis, Cassandra, Hadoop, etc
- Understand how various systems work
- Understand how IT operations are managed
- Manage source control including SVN and GIT

Estimated Salary:

\$100,000+ (depending on experience)

FRONT-END DEVELOPER: *best for alumni who are passionate about front-end technologies. Good entry-level position that requires passion and general skill in coding.*

Transferable Skills:

Customer Service

Client Relations

Project Management

Data Analysis

Problem Solving

Quality Assurance

Project Management

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General Job Description:

- Develop new user-facing features
- Build reusable code and libraries for future use
- Ensure the technical feasibility of UI/UX designs
- Optimize application for maximum speed and scalability
- Assure that all user input is validated before submitting to back-end
- Collaborate with other team members and stakeholders
- Proficient understanding of web markup, including HTML5, CSS3
- Basic understanding of server-side CSS pre-processing platforms, such as LESS and SASS
- Good understanding of asynchronous request handling, partial page updates, and AJAX

Estimated Salary:

\$60,000+ (depending on experience)

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT: *best for alumni who have some prior development or project management experience. Perhaps a good fit for individuals with some graphic design or marketing experience as well.*

Transferable Skills:

Scheduling

Data Analysis

Project Management

Team Management

Client Services

Marketing and Data Science

General Job Responsibilities:

- Determines customers' needs and desires by specifying the research needed to obtain market information.
- Recommends the nature and scope of present and future product lines by reviewing product specifications and requirements; appraising new product ideas and/or product or packaging changes.
- Assesses market competition by comparing the company's product to competitors' products.
- Provides source data for product line communications by defining product marketing communication objectives.
- Obtains product market share by working with sales director to develop product sales strategies.
- Assesses product market data by calling on customers with field salespeople and evaluating sales call results.
- Provides information for management by preparing short-term and long-term product sales forecasts and special reports and analyses; answering questions and requests.

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- Facilitates inventory turnover and product availability by reviewing and adjusting inventory levels and production schedules.
- Brings new products to market by analyzing proposed product requirements and product development programs; preparing return-on-investment analyses; establishing time schedules with engineering and manufacturing.
- Introduces and markets new products by developing time-integrated plans with sales, advertising, and production.
- Determines product pricing by utilizing market research data; reviewing production and sales costs; anticipating volume; costing special and customized orders.
- Completes operational requirements by scheduling and assigning employees; following up on work results.
- Maintains product management staff by recruiting, selecting, orienting, and training employees.
- Maintains product management staff job results by counseling and disciplining employees; planning, monitoring, and appraising job results.

Estimated Salary: 65,000 - 90,000+ (depending on experience and location)

SALES ENGINEER: *best for individuals with strong interpersonal skills, love for sales and a good understanding of client needs.*

Transferable Skills:

Sales

Finance

Client Relations

Project Management

Customer Service

Troubleshooting

General Job Responsibilities:

- Identifies current and future customer service requirements by establishing personal rapport with potential and actual customers and other persons in a position to understand service requirements. Provides product, service, or equipment technical and engineering information by answering questions and requests.
- Establishes new accounts and services accounts by identifying potential customers; planning and organizing sales call schedule.
- Prepares cost estimates by studying blueprints, plans, and related customer documents; consulting with engineers, architects, and other professional and technical personnel.
- Determines improvements by analyzing cost-benefit ratios of equipment, supplies, or service applications in customer environment; engineering or proposing changes in equipment, processes, or use of materials or services.
- Gains customer acceptance by explaining or demonstrating cost reductions and operations improvements.

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- Submits orders by conferring with technical support staff; costing engineering changes.
- Develops customer's staff by providing technical information and training.
- Complies with federal, state, and local legal requirements by studying existing and new legislation; anticipating future legislation; advising customer on product, service, or equipment adherence to requirements; advising customer on needed actions.
- Prepares sales engineering reports by collecting, analyzing, and summarizing sales information and engineering and application trends.
- Maintains professional and technical knowledge by attending educational workshops; reviewing professional publications; establishing personal networks; participating in professional societies.
- Contributes to sales engineering effectiveness by identifying short-term and long-range issues that must be addressed; providing information and commentary pertinent to deliberations; recommending options and courses of action; implementing directives.
- Contributes to team effort by accomplishing related results as needed.

Estimated Salary:

\$85,000+ (depending on experience) Often times commission packages can also affect salary for this position.

SCRUM MASTER/PROJECT MANAGER: *best for alumni with a strong corporate work history and team or project management backgrounds.*

Transferable Skills:

Customer Service
Management
Leadership
Financial Planning
Project Management

General Job Responsibilities:

- Confer with management, production, and marketing staff to discuss project specifications and procedures.
- Coordinate and direct projects, making detailed plans to accomplish goals and directing the integration of technical activities.
- Analyze technology, resource needs, and market demand, to plan and assess the feasibility of projects.
- Plan and direct the installation, testing, operation, maintenance, and repair of facilities and equipment.
- Direct, review, and approve product design and changes.
- Recruit employees; assign, direct, and evaluate their work; and oversee the development and maintenance of staff competence.
- Prepare budgets, bids, and contracts, and direct the negotiation of research contracts.

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- Develop and implement policies, standards and procedures for the engineering and technical work performed in the department, service, laboratory or firm.
- Perform administrative functions such as reviewing and writing reports, approving expenditures, enforcing rules, and making decisions about the purchase of materials or services.
- Review and recommend or approve contracts and cost estimates.
- Present and explain proposals, reports, and findings to clients.
- Consult or negotiate with clients to prepare project specifications.

Estimated Salary:

80,000 to 100,000+ (dependant on location and years of experience)

SOFTWARE ENGINEER: *best for alumni who are very mathematical and love intense problem solving and analysis*

Transferable Skills:

Data Analysis
Problem Solving
Client Relations
Project Management
Mathematics
Analytics

General Job Responsibilities:

- Developing and directing software system validation and testing methods.
- Directing our software programming initiatives
- Overseeing the development of documentation.
- Working closely with clients and cross-functional departments to communicate project statuses and proposals.
- Analyzing data to effectively coordinate the installation of new systems or the modification of existing systems.
- Managing the software development lifecycle.
- Monitoring system performance.
- Communicating key project data to team members and building cohesion among teams.
- Developing and executing project plans.
- Applying mathematics and statistics to problem-solving initiatives.
- Applying best practices and standard operating procedures.
- Creating innovative solutions to meet our company's technical needs.
- Testing new software and fixing bugs.

Estimated Salary: 75,000+ (depending on experience)

SOLUTIONS ENGINEER: *best for alumni who are customer and solutions-focused with a knack for problem solving skills.*

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Transferable Skills:

Problem Solving
IT
Client Management
Customer Services
Troubleshooting
Analytics
Finance
Mathematics
Quality Assurance

General Job Responsibilities:

- Well versed in the construction of reports, interfaces, data conversions, and customization or extensions to the Model N Revenue Management suite of applications.
- Ensures systems changes are tested properly.
- Work with software vendor for issue resolution and support patch deployment activities.
- Provide Level-3 support for ticket escalations requiring technical resolution and troubleshooting by understanding Model-N platform with respect to data, system jobs, data flow and web services.
- Work with the vendor to provide performance improvement custom solutions to enhance system capabilities.
- Follows IT compliance and team procedures to initiate change control of system changes to be implemented.
- In depth SME level support to ensure the daily and month/year end Model-N /SAP data interfaces are completed and period closing data is sent to stakeholders.
- Document issues resolution with adequate details to support system audits.
- Provide after hour support as per operational support needs.
- Interprets/authors business requirements, functional and technical design documents for projects.
- Architect and implement solutions for requirements across Model-N suite. Provides technical assessment for project requests submitted by customers. Recommends how Model N can be best changed, designed and/or configured to meet customer needs.
- Undertake lead technical/BA/Test responsibilities in both patch deployment and major system upgrade activities such as evaluating/upgrading customization code and ensuring base package deployment is deployed providing seamless operation upon go-live.

Estimated Salary:

\$85,000+ (depending on experience)

TECHNICAL LEAD: *best for alumni who already have some prior development experience under their belts as well as something with a knack for organization and project management.*

Transferable Skills:

Finance

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Quality Assurance
Customer Support
Management
Project Management
Client Relations
Troubleshooting
Data Analysis

General Job Description:

- Collaborate and consult with select server and core server clients to implement successful server launches, and to resolve highly complex technical issues associated with deployment
- Partner with clients and help them optimize the use of Tableau Software
- Lead support case resolution efforts for prescribed customer cases
- Extensively research and document customer software and technical issues
- Collaborate with User Support, Escalation Engineering and Sales Consultants to identify high priority server issues and partner with Development and Quality Engineering teams as needed
- Mentor Technical Support Engineers in researching, resolving and documenting customer server issues
- Act as the primary technical liaison between customers and other Tableau departments as issues are resolved
- Develop, document, mentor, and train others in support procedures for server-related technical triage and problem solving

Estimated Salary:

\$80,000+ (depending on experience)

UX/UI DESIGNER: *best for alumni who love design and thinking about how people interact with products. Generally individuals who took a liking to front-end technologies.*

Transferable Skills:

Art and Illustration
Graphic Design
Marketing
Photoshop
Photography
Interior Design
Customer Support

General Job Responsibilities:

- Gathering and evaluating user requirements, in collaboration with product managers and engineers
- Illustrating design ideas using storyboards, process flows and sitemaps
- Designing graphic user interface elements, like menus, tabs and widgets

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- Gather and evaluate user requirements in collaboration with product managers and engineers
- Illustrate design ideas using storyboards, process flows and sitemaps
- Design graphic user interface elements, like menus, tabs and widgets
- Build page navigation buttons and search fields
- Develop UI mockups and prototypes that clearly illustrate how sites function and look like
- Create original graphic designs (e.g. images, sketches and tables)
- Prepare and present rough drafts to internal teams and key stakeholders
- Identify and troubleshoot UX problems (e.g. responsiveness)
- Conduct layout adjustments based on user feedback
- Adhere to style standards on fonts, colors and images

Estimated Salary:

\$60,000+ (dependant on experience and location)

WEB DEVELOPER/FULL STACK DEVELOPER: *best for alumni who have took strongly to all aspects of the bootcamp and have equally strong front-end and back-end skills.*

Transferable Skills:

Client Management

Customer Service

Planning

Data Analysis

Mathematics

Information Technology

Language

General Job Responsibilities:

1. Writing well designed, testable, efficient code by using best software development practices
2. Creating website layout/user interfaces by using standard HTML/CSS practices
3. Integrating data from various back-end services and databases
4. Write well designed, testable, efficient code by using best software development practices
5. Create website layout/user interface by using standard HTML/CSS practices
6. Integrate data from various back-end services and databases
7. Gather and refine specifications and requirements based on technical needs
8. Create and maintain software documentation
9. Be responsible for maintaining, expanding, and scaling our site
10. Stay plugged into emerging technologies/industry trends and apply them into operations and activities
11. Cooperate with web designers to match visual design intent

Estimated Salary:

\$55,000 + (dependent on location and experience)

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ENGINEER IN TEST: *best for alumni who have a general understanding of all aspects of development and enjoy testing, troubleshooting and identifying bugs.*

Transferable Skills:

Quality Assurance

Mathematics

Finance

Data Analysis

Information Technology

Detail Oriented

Troubleshooting

General Job Responsibilities:

- Provide design for testability (DFT) input to product development teams and analyze test coverage across multiple test technologies
- Develop detailed test procedures including test configurations and test equipment requirements
- Develop and execute test approaches and procedures for hardware, software and system level testing
- Provide system architecture and subsystem designs for implementing system requirements
- Develop documentation
- Identifies, analyzes and resolves system problems
- Provides technical leadership within complex and diverse engineering projects
- Assists in the establishment of pricing and bid proposals
- Employs creative problem solving techniques
- Special projects and other duties as assigned by management
- Specifies system level issues and design considerations such as interface circuitry for complex test systems
- Interfaces to clients on a regular basis
- Supports proposal efforts including delineating and estimating tasks in complex test systems
- Identifies areas of high risk in project work and leads the risk mitigation effort for the team
- Exhibits Root Cause Analysis skills when it comes to electrical issues in test systems
- Mentors junior system engineers

Estimated Salary:

\$70,000+ (depending on experience)

QA TESTER: *best for alumni who are very data driven and detail-oriented. Keen eye for identifying bugs and general testing. Great entry-level role*

Transferable Skills:

Customer Services

QA

Data Analysis

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Information Technology
Troubleshooting

General Job Responsibilities:

- Interacts with other engineering groups to define, document, analyze, perform, and interpret tests for products, systems, components, or modifications.
- Identifies functional problems and suggests resolutions. Assists in the definition of internal quality control standards and the maintenance of reliability programs.
- Documents and analyzes test cases and provides regular progress reports.
- Ensures testing procedures are in compliance with any required industry specific standards. Works on projects/matters of limited complexity in a support role.
- Work is closely managed.
- Typically requires 0-2 years of related experience.

Estimated Salary:

45,000 - 65,000 (dependent on location and experience)

TECHNICAL SUPPORT: *best for alumni who are still fine-tuning their coding skills and have a good understanding of SQL and SAAS.*

Transferable Skills:

Customer Service
Call Center
Retail
Information Technology
Troubleshooting
Quality Assurance

General Job Responsibilities:

- Working with customers/employees to identify computer problems and advising on the solution
- Logging and keeping records of customer/employee queries
- Analysing call logs so you can spot common trends and underlying problems
- Updating self-help documents so customers/employees can try to fix problems themselves
- Working with field engineers to visit customers/employees if the problem is more serious
- Testing and fixing faulty equipment

Estimated Salary:

\$45,000+ (dependent on location and experience)

II. CODING DOJO GRADUATE POSITION TITLES

Below is a list of some of the titles our graduates were hired into after they completed the bootcamp. It is important to note that some companies will have slight variations on titles for the

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same general position. Look through this list and do a little bit of resource to open your horizons on what all is out there. The world is your oyster!

Coding Bootcamp Instructor
Engineering Apprentice
Cryptocurrency Developer
Web Developer
Web Engineer
Software Developer
Software Engineer
Full Stack Developer
Front-End Developer
Ruby Developer
.Net Developer
Full Stack Web Developer
Digital Producer
Client Integration Engineer
Python Developer
DevOps
Software Test Engineer
Workflow Developer
QA Tester
SCRUM Master
Product Manager
Tech Lead
Application Analyst
Web Designer
UX/UI Developer

III. ADDITIONAL READING MATERIAL

https://www.huffingtonpost.com/entry/the-multiple-career-paths-that-attending-a-coding-bootcamp_us_59f77e33e4b0e4c2eab1c2e8

**Article about the Career Paths/jobs available to bootcamp grads after graduation*

<https://www.forbes.com/sites/laurencebradford/2016/10/28/11-careers-you-can-land-after-attending-a-coding-bootcamp/#7f7a7ff34a38>

**Article discusses Top 11 careers that bootcamp grads land in after completing their respective bootcamps*

<http://blog.indeed.com/2017/05/02/what-employers-think-about-coding-bootcamp/>

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** Article discusses what employers think about bootcamp grads and how they believe they stack up against folks with CS Degrees*

<http://blog.indeed.com/2017/02/21/indeed-diversity-survey-results/>

**Article discusses the need for more diversity in Tech. There is a section that discusses how employers are seeing bootcamp grads as a way to not only increase diversity numbers, but to also bring in quality folks*

<https://www.themuse.com/advice/i-went-to-a-coding-bootcamp-and-heres-what-happened-next>

**Muse article about experiences of several bootcamp grads and their job search after graduating. One of our Seattle grads is featured.*

<http://blog.galvanize.com/10-ways-bootcamp-grads-can-land-programming-jobs/>

**Article about 10 ways bootcamp grads can set themselves apart from others*

<http://www.businessinsider.com/coding-bootcamp-grad-goes-from-chick-fil-a-to-making-90000-after-6-months-of-study-2015-7>

**Article about a former Chick-Fil-A employee who now makes 90k after attending a Coding Bootcamp (Video included)*

<https://medium.freecodecamp.org/5-key-learnings-from-the-post-bootcamp-job-search-9a07468d2331>

**Article is about the 5 things the student learned about finding a job post-bootcamp. Really good info on making the job search process easier*

<https://www.jobstart.com/posts/job-hunting-101-for-coding-bootcamp-graduates>

**Article highlighting the difficulties facing bootcamp grads when hitting the job market and the different approach/viewpoint they should take towards their search*

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VB7qRpQBR4U>

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